

Viewers can also control MPC through the interface by clicking on the relevant link.

Converting To DSM (Direct Show Media) Format

You can convert any file that MPC can play into DSM format. For this access the File > Utils menu. Right-click on the DSM converter window and add the file you want to convert. Then click on save as to provide a location and name to the converted file. To start encoding, click on start.

Concluding Remarks

For: An excellent video player which will play anything as long as the relevant codec is installed. Being able to hear audio when the movie rate is altered is also a nice touch. Add-ons like inbuilt capturing capability and HTTP server set it apart from other free media players.

Against: In the attempt to reduce bloat, MPC even did away with a help file, though for routine use the intuitive interface is child's play. The user manual, if needed, can be downloaded from the home page. Those interested in viewing their movies embossed or inverted, etc., will be disappointed, since MPC does not allow this easily. Encoding to DSM may not find many takers, so that feature is not of much practical use.

Overall, it is a must for all PCs, and it is automatically installed when you install the K-Lite Mega Codec Pack.

3.1.2 Video LAN Client (VLC) Media Player

Platforms: Linux, Windows, Mac OS X, BeOS, etc.

Home page: www.videolan.org

As the name implies, this started off as a project to create a video streaming server and playback client. Originally, there was a Video Lan Server and a Video Lan Client for each of the functions. But the crossplatform media player gained popularity and soon the server was reduced to a component of the Media player. This is a